



Leave It Better

A Family Camping Kindness & Clean-Up Kit

Teach your kids to care for nature, respect other campers,
and leave every campsite better than they found it, one fun
mission at a time.

FOR FAMILIES · AGES 4 TO 10

FOR THE GROWN-UPS

Welcome, camp leader 🖐️

A quick note before your trip, then the kids take over.

Kids do not learn to respect nature from a lecture. They learn it from doing, from small missions that feel like a game and make them feel proud. That is exactly what this kit is.

Inside you will find two things working together: simple ground rules for the whole family (noise, neighbors, clean-up, wildlife), and games and badges that turn your kids into "Junior Rangers" who actually want to pick up litter and keep the campsite calm.

You do not need to be perfect or know everything about the outdoors. You just need to show up and do it together. That is the whole secret.



How to use this kit

Print the whole thing, or just the pages you want. Read the family rules together in the car. Let kids earn badges during the trip. Sign the pledge on night one.

💛 **The only rule that matters:** it does not have to be perfect, it just has to happen. Every little action your kids take today becomes a habit that protects the outdoors for their whole life.

The Good Neighbor Code

A campsite is a shared space. These are the unwritten rules that make you the family everyone is happy to camp next to.



Respect quiet hours

Most campgrounds have quiet hours (often 10pm to 7am). Voices, laughter, and car doors carry far at night. Keep it low after dark.



Music stays at your site

If your neighbor can hear your speaker, it is too loud. Many people camp for the quiet of nature. Use low volume, or headphones.



Do not cut through other sites

A campsite is someone's temporary home. Walk the roads and paths, do not shortcut through a neighbor's space, even if it is faster.



Point lights down

Bright lanterns and headlamps blind everyone around you. Aim lights at the ground and dim them at night so everyone can see the stars.



Keep pets leashed and quiet

Leash your dog, clean up after it, and do not let it bark all night. Not everyone loves your pet as much as you do, and that is okay.



Never leave a fire alone

An unattended fire is dangerous for the whole campground. Drown it, stir it, and drown it again until it is cold before bed or leaving.

THE BIG IDEA

Leave No Trace

Seven simple ideas that mean one thing: leave nature exactly as you found it, or better. Read these with your kids.

1

Plan ahead

Know the rules of where you are going and pack what you need so you are not caught off guard.

2

Stay on the trail

Walk and camp on marked paths and spots so plants and soil stay healthy.

3

Pack out your trash

Everything you bring in, you take out. If you packed it, you carry it home, even tiny wrappers.

4

Leave what you find

Rocks, flowers, sticks, and bugs belong to nature. Look, enjoy, take a photo, leave it there.

5

Be careful with fire

Only in fire rings, keep it small, and make sure it is fully cold before you walk away.

6

Respect wildlife

Watch animals from far away. Never feed them, human food makes them sick and unsafe.

★ **The 7th rule:** be kind to other people. Share the trail, keep the noise down, and smile. The outdoors belongs to everyone.

FOR THE KIDS

Become a Junior Ranger!

Rangers are the helpers who protect nature. Now it is your turn.

A Junior Ranger is a kid who takes care of the outdoors like a real hero. On this trip, you can earn 6 badges. Do the mission for each badge, then color it in or put a sticker on it. Earn all 6 and you get your official certificate at the end!

1

Do the mission

Each badge has one easy job to do while you camp.

2

Color or sticker your badge

When you finish, fill in the badge on the next page.

3

Earn your certificate

Collect all 6 and a grown-up signs your Junior Ranger certificate!



Ready, Ranger? Turn the page to see your 6 badges. You can start the very first minute you arrive at camp!

FOR THE KIDS

Your 6 Ranger Badges 🌟

Do the mission, then color the badge or add a sticker in the circle.



Clean-Up Hero

Pick up 10 pieces of litter (even if they are not yours).



Quiet Camper

Use an inside voice after dark for a whole night.



Wildlife Watcher

Spot an animal and watch it from far away, no feeding.



Trail Keeper

Stay on the path the whole hike, no shortcuts.



Fire Safety Star

Help a grown-up check the fire is cold before bed.



Kindness Badge

Say hi or help a neighbor camper or a family member.



Trash Treasure Hunt

A scavenger hunt, but backwards! Instead of taking things FROM nature, you find trash and take it OUT. Use gloves or a bag. Check a box for each thing you find and throw away the right way.

- ☐ A candy or snack wrapper
- ☐ A plastic bottle or can
- ☐ A piece of paper or cardboard
- ☐ A bottle cap or bread tie
- ☐ A piece of plastic bag
- ☐ Something that does not belong in nature
- ☐ A tiny piece of litter most people would miss
- ☐ BONUS: fill a whole bag with your family!

 **You win when:** you leave your campsite cleaner than you found it. Found 5 or more? You just earned your **Clean-Up Hero** badge!

Leave No Trace Bingo

Do a good deed for nature and mark that square. Get 5 in a row, up, down, or sideways, to win!

 Threw away my trash	 Stayed on the trail	 Left a flower where it grew	 Used a quiet voice at night	 Did not waste water
 Watched an animal from far	 Kept away from the fire	 Said hi to a neighbor	 Left sticks and rocks alone	 Picked up someone else's litter
 Ate without feeding animals	 Pointed my light down	 FREE Ranger space	 Cleaned up my own mess	 Was gentle with pets
 Hugged a tree (left it there!)	 Took my bathroom trash with me	 Packed out what I packed in	 Was kind to my family	 Sorted a recyclable
 Told someone why nature matters	 Went to bed without noise	 Helped clean the campsite	 Let the bugs be	 Did not cut through a site

Spot & Fix the Campsite

Read each little story together. Ask your kids: what is wrong here, and how would a Junior Ranger fix it? Answers are underneath.

 A family is playing loud music at 10pm and the campers next door cannot sleep.

Fix: Turn the music down or off after quiet hours. Nature and neighbors need rest too.

 Someone dropped a candy wrapper on the trail and kept walking.

Fix: Pick it up and pack it out. A real Ranger even grabs trash that is not theirs.

 A camper is leaving food out to "make friends" with a raccoon.

Fix: Never feed wild animals. Human food makes them sick. Store food away and watch from afar.

 A kid picked a big handful of wildflowers to take home.

Fix: Leave what you find. Take a photo instead so the next family can enjoy them too.

 A family is packing the car with the campfire still smoking.

Fix: Drown it, stir it, and drown it again until it is cold. Never leave a fire alone.

The Quiet Camper Mission 🤫

Sound travels far in nature, especially at night. Learn your "outdoor voice levels" and earn your Quiet Camper badge.

0

Nature voice

Silent. For watching animals and listening to the forest.

1

Whisper

Only the person next to you can hear. Perfect after dark.

2

Inside voice

Calm and low. Good for talking around the campfire.

3

Big voice

Save it for open trails and daytime play, away from other camps.

🌙 **Your mission:** after the sun goes down, keep your voice at level 1 or 2 for the whole night. Do it and color in your **Quiet Camper** badge!

Leave It Better Checklist

The most important pages! Before you drive away, walk the site together and check every box. This is how you leave it better than you found it.

- ☐ All trash picked up and packed out (look under the table!)
- ☐ Fire is drowned, stirred, and completely COLD to the touch
- ☐ No food scraps or crumbs left on the ground
- ☐ Tent spot cleared, nothing left behind
- ☐ Rocks, logs, and sticks put back where we found them
- ☐ Did a final "sweep" walk looking for tiny litter
- ☐ Picked up at least one piece of trash that was not ours
- ☐ Said thank you to the forest 🌲

 **Ranger challenge:** can a stranger tell your family camped here? If the answer is no, you did it perfectly.

Our Family Camp Pledge

Read this out loud together on your first night, then everyone signs.

"On this trip, our family promises to..."

 Leave every place better than we found it

 Pick up our trash, and some that is not ours

 Be quiet and kind to our camp neighbors

 Watch wildlife from far away and never feed it

 Be safe with fire, water, and each other

Because the outdoors belongs to everyone. 

GROWN-UP

JUNIOR RANGER

JUNIOR RANGER

DATE

YOU DID IT!

Junior Ranger Certificate



THIS CERTIFIES THAT

is an Official Junior Ranger

for earning all 6 badges and promising to leave the outdoors better than they found it.

RANGER SIGNATURE

DATE

✂ - - - - - CUT OUT YOUR RANGER CARD - - - - -



JUNIOR RANGER

Name: _____ · I protect the outdoors!

paolaadventurer.com

Quick-Reference Card

The whole kit in one glance. Snap a photo or print and clip it where you can see it.

Good neighbor basics

- Quiet hours after dark (usually 10pm–7am)
- Music low enough to stay at your own site
- Lights pointed down, dimmed at night
- Never cut through another family's site
- Pets leashed, cleaned up after, and quiet

Leave no trace

- Pack out everything you packed in
- Stay on trails, leave what you find
- Watch wildlife from afar, never feed it
- Fire: small, in the ring, cold before you leave

 Safety note: Always supervise children around fire, water, wildlife, and trails. This kit teaches good habits but does not replace adult supervision or your campground's specific rules. Check local regulations before your trip.

Thank you for raising kids who love the outdoors. 

— Paola